MIL-C-51278D
30 June 1987
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-51278C
28 March 1983

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CAP, WATER CANTEEN, FIELD, 1 QUART AND 2 QUART CANTEENS

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers a plastic canteen water cap for the 1 quart and 2 quart field drinking water canteens.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

* 2.1.1 Documents. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to U.S.: Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8465

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595 - Colors

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads

2.1.2 Other Government documents. The following other Government documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Part 177)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT, AND ENGINEERING CENTER

8-1-33 - Canteen, Water, Plastic, with Screw Cap; Assembly and Details

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5-81-118 - Cap
5-81-131 - Gasket
5-81-135 - Valve
5-81-137 - Connector, Female
5-81-138 - Bracket
5-81-139 - Cap
136-5-520-1 - Tester, Air Leakage, Canteen Cap, Q178 Data List
136-5-540-1 - Tester, Air Flow Resistance, Q179

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 638 - Tensile Properties of Plastics
D 790 - Flexural Properties of Unreinforced and Reinforced Plastics and Electrical Insulating Materials
D 792 - Specific Gravity and Density of Plastics by Displacement
D 1238 - Flow Rates of Thermoplastics by Extrusion Plastometer
D 1505 - Density of Plastics by the Density-Gradient Method
D 1693 - Environmental Stress Cracking of Ethylene Plastics
D 2176 - Folding Endurance of Paper by the M.I.T. Tester
D 2240 - Rubber Property - Durometer Hardness
D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence. Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.2, and 6.3).

3.2 Materials and components. The materials and components shall be as specified herein and on the applicable drawings. Materials and components not definitely specified shall be of the quality normally used by the manufacturer provided the completed item complies with all the provisions of this document.

* 3.2.1 Plastic. The plastic material for the cap shall be virgin polypropylene copolymer conforming to the requirements specified in table I when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1. The use of reground material shall not be permitted.

TABLE I. Polypropylene requirements

Characteristic	Requirement
Density	0.902 grams (± 0.002 gram) per cubic centimeter
Melt index	3.8 grams ± 0.4 decigrams per minute
Tensile strength	4,000 pounds per square inch (psi)
Elongation at yield	8 percent minimum
Hardness	79 ± 3.0 shore D
Tangent modulus of elasticity (Flexural modulus)	150,000 psi, minimum
Environmental stress cracking resistance	45 hours F50, minimum
Color	Natural

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* 3.2.1.1 Toxicity. The polypropylene used in the manufacture of the cap plus other materials used in the fabrication of the plastic shall conform to the requirements of 21 CFR Part 177 - Indirect Food Additives: Polymers (see 4.4.1.2).

3.3 Design and construction. The design and construction of the cap assembly shall be as specified herein and shown on 5-81-139 and subsidiary drawings.

3.4 Molded cap requirements.

3.4.1 Molding method. The molded cap (Drawing 5-81-118) shall be injection molded from the plastic material specified in 3.2.1.

* 3.4.2 Color. The color of the M1 cap shall approximate Olive Drab 34087, lusterless, of FED-STD-595.

3.4.3 Environmental stress cracking resistance. The molded cap shall show no evidence of stress cracking when tested as specified in 4.4.2.2.

3.4.4 Torque strength. The molded cap shall not slip, disengage, or crack when tested as specified in 4.4.2.2.

3.4.5 Hinge strength. The molded cap hinge shall not split into two different pieces after 25,000 flexes with a load of 1.43 kilograms ± 0.03 kilogram when tested as specified in 4.4.2.2.

3.5 Assembled cap requirements.

3.5.1 Leakage resistance. The cap assembly shall not leak when tested as specified in 4.4.5.

3.5.2 Air flow resistance. The cap assembly shall have an air flow resistance no greater than 1.0 inch of water when tested as specified in 4.4.5.

3.6 Workmanship. The cap shall be free from fractures, splits, punctures, tears, dents, deteriorations, or malformations. The exterior surfaces of the cap shall have a smooth and lusterless finish throughout and shall be free of dirt, dust, grease and foreign matter. The finish shall be produced from a die which has cavity surfaces finished in vapor blast, water hone or similar satin finish and not by the application of any protective coating, lacquers or other materials.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this document shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirement in the document shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

* 4.1.2 Responsibility for dimensional requirements. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for assuring that all specified dimensions have been met. When dimensions cannot be examined on the end item, inspection shall be made at any point or at all points in the manufacturing process necessary to assure compliance with all dimensional requirements.

4.1.3 Certificates of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to inspect such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in table IV and tested as specified in 4.4.4 and 4.5.1 through 4.5.5. The presence of any defect or failure to pass any test shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

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4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

* 4.4.1.1 Material certification. The polypropylene material for the cap shall be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certificate of compliance with the characteristics listed in table II.

TABLE II. Plastic raw material tests

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Density	Table I	ASTM D 1505, Method B or D 792 Method A or B
Melt index	Table I	ASTM D 1238, Procedure A, condition E
Tensile strength	Table I	ASTM D 638, type IV specimens
Elongation at yield	Table I	ASTM D 638, type IV specimens
Hardness	Table I	ASTM D 2240
Tangent modulus of elasticity	Table I	ASTM D 790, Procedure B
Environmental stress cracking resistance	Table I	ASTM D 1693 test as for type I
Color	Table I	Visual

4.4.1.2 Toxicity certification. A certificate of compliance will be acceptable as evidence of conformance to the toxicity requirements specified in 3.2.1.1.

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4.4.1.3 Cap components (other than cap shell) certification. A certificate of compliance will be acceptable as evidence that the gasket, valves, female connector, bracket, or spring conforms to the material and dimensional requirements specified on Drawing 5-81-131, 5-81-135, 5-81-137, or 5-81-138, whichever is applicable.

4.4.2 In-process inspection.

4.4.2.1 Mold approval. Prior to use in regular production, each mold shall be used to produce an initial production lot of cap shells and one cap shell shall be randomly selected from that lot. The cap shell shall be examined for conformance to all dimensions specified on the applicable drawing. If the cap is found to conform to all dimensional requirements, the related mold shall be approved. If the cap shell fails to conform to any dimensional requirement, an additional five cap shells shall be randomly selected from the initial production lot and examined for all dimensions. If any additional cap shell fails to conform to any dimension, the related mold and initial production lot shall be rejected. When any mold is repaired or altered in any way, mold reapproval in accordance with the above procedure is required.

4.4.2.2 In-process testing of cap shells. Prior to beginning regular production, four cap shells shall be selected at random from the initial production lot and tested as specified in table III. Any test failure shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Necessary changes to the materials and procedure shall be made and testing as above shall be repeated. Whenever any change in material or manufacturing process is made, the initial lot produced after the change shall be tested as above.

TABLE III. Molded cap shells in-process tests

Characteristic	Requirement	Test method	Number of samples
Environmental stress cracking resistance	3.4.3	4.5.3	10
Torque strength	3.4.4	4.5.4	25
Hinge strength	3.4.5	4.5.5	25

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* 4.4.3 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed in table IV. The lot size shall be expressed in units of caps. The sample unit shall be one cap. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total (major and minor combined) defects.

TABLE IV. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Finish	Color not as specified	101	
	Dirt, grease, oil, foreign matter, undisposed pigment, dark particles of burnt material, porosity	102	
Design, construction and workmanship general (applicable to all components and assemblies)	Any component or part missing or not specified type or size	103	
	Fractured, split, punctured, torn, dented, deteriorated, or malformed	104	
	Component misplaced or not in proper alignment		201
	Sharp burr, edge, or sliver		202
	Component loose		203
	Any operation omitted or not properly performed	105	
	Any functioning component that is inoperative or will not operate as intended	106	
	Any functioning component that requires abnormal force to operate		204
	Any visible weld on the strap for the cover	107	

* 4.4.4 End item dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined for conformance to the dimensions annotated with an asterisk on the drawings. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect.

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The lot shall be expressed in units of water canteen caps. The sample unit shall be one water canteen cap. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

4.4.5 End item testing. The end item shall be tested for leak resistance as specified in 4.5.1 and for air flow resistance as specified in 4.5.2. The lot size shall be expressed in units of caps. The sample unit shall be one complete cap assembly. The inspection level shall be II. Any test failure shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4.6 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete sealing or closure of flap, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted container
Content	Number of intermediate containers is more or less than specified Number of caps per intermediate container is more or less than required 1/

1/ For this defect, one intermediate container shall be examined.

4.4.7 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1, and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

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body, outer cover, outer neck tube, evacuation tube, and an evacuation cap

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified Interlocking of loads not as specified Load not bonded with required straps as specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

4.5 Methods of inspection.

4.5.1 Cap leakage test. Using the Q178 tester (Drawing 136-5-520-1), the cap assembly shall be tested at a pressure differential of 3 inches of mercury for a minimum of 5 seconds. Any nonconformance to the leakage requirement of 3.5.1 shall constitute failure of the test.

4.5.2 Cap air flow test. Using the Q179 tester (Drawing 136-5-540-1), the cap assembly shall be tested at an air flow of 2.0 liters per minute. Any nonconformance to the air resistance requirements of 3.5.2 shall constitute failure of the test.

4.5.3 Cap environmental stress cracking resistance test. The molded cap shall be immersed in a 5 percent Igepal solution at 122 ± 2°F for a period of 96 hours. Any nonconformance to the requirements of 3.4.3 shall constitute failure of the test.

4.5.4 Cap torque test. The molded cap shall be placed on a mandrel made to the dimensions of the neck of the 1 quart water canteen (Drawing 8-1-33) and a torque of 100 inch-pounds applied. Any nonconformance to the requirements of 3.4.4 shall constitute failure of the test.

4.5.5 Cap hinge strength test. The molded cap strap shall be trimmed flush with the cap and mounted and tested as specified in ASTM D 2176 such that center line of the rotating part of the hinge coincides with the center line of the other part of the hinge. Any nonconformance to the requirements of 3.4.5 shall constitute failure of the test.

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packing. Each cap shall be unit packed in a clear, flat-style polyethylene film bag of 0.002 inch thickness (± 20 percent tolerance). The bag may be fabricated from polyethylene film, tubing, or sheeting. The polyethylene bag shall be formed with heat sealed seams that are straight and continuous. Bag closure may be effected by heat sealing, stapling, taping, or by means of a tuck or reverse flap.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packing. Ten caps, unit packed as specified in 5.1.1.1 shall be placed in an intermediate fiberboard box conforming to type CF, variety SW, minimum grade W6c, style RSC of PPP-B-636. The inside dimensions of each intermediate box shall be 9 1/2 inches in length, 4 inches in width, and 2 1/8 inches in depth (± 1/8 inch tolerance). The unit packs shall be placed five in length, two in width, and one in depth within each intermediate box. Box closure shall be accomplished in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

* 5.1.2 Commercial. Caps shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Level A packing. Three hundred and twenty caps preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. Level A intermediate packs shall be packed flat two in length, four in width, and four in depth within a shipping container. The inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be 20 inches in length, 18 inches in width, and 10 1/2 inches in depth. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

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5.2.2 Level B packing. Three hundred and twenty caps, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A intermediate packs shall be packed flat two in length, four in width, and four in depth within a shipping container. The inside dimensions of each shipping container shall be 20 inches in length, 18 inches in width, and 10 1/2 inches in depth. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

* 5.2.3 Commercial packing. Caps, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), caps, packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet type shall be type I (4-way entry), type IV or type V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L or film bonding means O or P. Pallet pattern shall be in accordance with appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course.

* 5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, intermediate containers, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

5.4.1 Polyethylene bagged unit packs. Polyethylene bagged unit packs shall have the required identification information legibly printed or stamped in black directly across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit ready identification.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The cap is intended for use with the 1 quart and 2 quart military field drinking water canteens.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).

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c. Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
d. Type and class of unit load required (see 5.2.1).
e. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
f. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

* 6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition instruments regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

* 6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Canteen
Cap, canteen
Water canteen

6.5 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document are marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only, and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content, as written, irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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Navy - NU
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Preparing activity:

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-51278D	Cap, Water Canteen, Field, 1 Quart and 2 Quart Canteens

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK OP, 1 Apr 84

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